

SENATE BILL NO. 163

INTRODUCED BY D. ZOLNIKOV

A BILL FOR AN ACT ENTITLED: "AN ACT REVISING THE GENETIC INFORMATION PRIVACY ACT;  
INCLUDING ~~NEURAL~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY DATA IN THE SCOPE OF THE GENETIC INFORMATION  
PRIVACY ACT; ADDING LEGISLATIVE FINDINGS AND PURPOSE TO THE ACT; REVISING PROVISIONS  
RELATING TO EXCEPTIONS; ADDING PROTECTIONS FOR THE PRIVACY OF ~~NEURAL~~  
NEUROTECHNOLOGY DATA; REVISING PROVISIONS RELATING TO PRIVACY NOTICES; PROVIDING A  
DEFINITION; AND AMENDING SECTIONS 30-23-101, 30-23-102, 30-23-103, 30-23-104, 30-23-105, AND 44-  
6-104, MCA."

BE IT ENACTED BY THE LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF MONTANA:

**Section 1.** Section 30-23-101, MCA, is amended to read:

**"30-23-101. Short title -- legislative findings and declaration of purpose.** (1) This part may be  
cited as the "Genetic Information Privacy Act".

(2) The legislature finds and declares that:

(a) (i) the people of Montana regard their privacy as a fundamental right and an essential element  
of individual freedom; and

(ii) Article II, section 10, of the Montana constitution protects individuals' privacy, and fundamental  
privacy rights have long been, and continue to be, integral to protecting Montanans;

(b) ongoing advances in technology have produced exponential growth in the volume and variety  
of personal data being generated, collected, stored, and analyzed, and these advances present both great  
promise and potential risks;

(c) technology that collects data about the user's bodily and mental functions is transforming the  
volume and sensitivity of personal data collected from individuals and stored by companies;

(d) neurotechnologies, including devices capable of recording, interpreting, and altering the  
response of an individual's central or peripheral nervous system to its internal or external environment, raise

1 particularly pressing privacy concerns given their ability to monitor, decode, and manipulate brain activity;

2 (e) data concerning the activity of the human brain and wider nervous systems, or "neural  
3 NEUROTECHNOLOGY data", is extremely sensitive and can reveal intimate information about individuals, including  
4 information about health, mental states, emotions, and cognitive functioning;

5 (f) each human brain is unique, meaning that neural data is specific to the individual from whom it  
6 is collected. Because ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data contains distinctive information about the structure and  
7 functioning of individual brains and nervous systems, it contains sensitive information that may link the data to  
8 an identified or identifiable individual.

9 (g) the collection of ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data involves the involuntary disclosure of  
10 information. Even if individuals consent to the collection and processing of their data for narrow use, they are  
11 unlikely to be fully aware of the content or quality of information they are sharing.

12 (h) neurotechnology users cannot decide what specific ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY information they  
13 would like to disclose, and they are unlikely to understand the extent to which their ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY  
14 data can be decoded, currently or in the future. Neurotechnologies can collect and process information about  
15 an individual that the individual did not even know existed.

16 (i) neurotechnologies that are deployed in medical settings or otherwise utilize the surgical  
17 implantation of invasive devices are typically regulated as medical tools that produce health information. Both  
18 invasive and noninvasive wearable neurotechnologies used in medical settings are also regulated by health  
19 data privacy laws. However, when noninvasive neurotechnologies are used outside of medical settings, they  
20 are generally considered consumer products and operate without regulation or data protection standards."

21  
22 **Section 2.** Section 30-23-102, MCA, is amended to read:

23 **"30-23-102. Definitions.** As used in this part, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise, the  
24 following definitions apply:

25 (1) "Biological sample" means any human material known to contain DNA, including tissue, blood,  
26 urine, or saliva.

27 (2) "Consumer" means an individual who is a resident of this state.

28 (3) "DNA" means deoxyribonucleic acid.

(4) "Entity" means a partnership, corporation, association, or public or private organization of any character that:

(a) offers consumer genetic testing products or services directly to a consumer; or

(b) collects, uses, or analyzes genetic data.

(5) "Express consent" means a consumer's affirmative response to a clear, meaningful, and prominent notice regarding the collection, use, or disclosure of genetic data for a specific purpose.

(6) (a) "Genetic data" means any data, regardless of format, concerning a consumer's genetic characteristics.

(b) The term includes but is not limited to:

(i) raw sequence data that result from sequencing all or a portion of a consumer's extracted DNA;

(ii) genotypic and phenotypic information obtained from analyzing a consumer's raw sequence data; and

(iii) self-reported health information regarding a consumer's health conditions that the consumer provides to an entity that the entity:

(A) uses for scientific research or product development; and

(B) analyzes in connection with the consumer's raw sequence data.

(7) "Genetic testing" means:

(a) a laboratory test of a consumer's complete DNA, regions of DNA, chromosomes, genes, or gene products to determine the presence of genetic characteristics of a consumer; or

(b) an interpretation of a consumer's genetic data.

(8) "Governmental agency" means an executive, legislative, or judicial agency, department, board, commission, authority, institution, or instrumentality of the federal government or of a state or of a county, municipality, or other political subdivision of a state.

~~(9) "Neural data" means information that is generated by the measurement of the activity of an individual's central or peripheral nervous systems and that can be processed by or with the assistance of a device.~~

~~(9) "NEUROTECHNOLOGY" MEANS DEVICES CAPABLE OF RECORDING, INTERPRETING, OR ALTERING THE RESPONSE OF AN INDIVIDUAL'S CENTRAL OR PERIPHERAL NERVOUS SYSTEM TO ITS INTERNAL OR EXTERNAL~~

ENVIRONMENT AND INCLUDES MENTAL AUGMENTATION, WHICH MEANS IMPROVING HUMAN COGNITION AND BEHAVIOR THROUGH DIRECT RECORDING OR MANIPULATION OF NEURAL ACTIVITY BY NEUROTECHNOLOGY.

(10) (A) "NEUROTECHNOLOGY DATA" MEANS INFORMATION THAT IS CAPTURED BY NEUROTECHNOLOGIES, IS GENERATED BY MEASURING THE ACTIVITY OF AN INDIVIDUAL'S CENTRAL OR PERIPHERAL NERVOUS SYSTEMS, OR IS DATA ASSOCIATED WITH NEURAL ACTIVITY, WHICH MEANS THE ACTIVITY OF NEURONS OR GLIAL CELLS IN THE CENTRAL OR PERIPHERAL NERVOUS SYSTEM, AND THAT IS NOT NONNEURAL INFORMATION.

(B) THE TERM DOES NOT INCLUDE NONNEURAL INFORMATION, WHICH MEANS INFORMATION ABOUT THE DOWNSTREAM PHYSICAL EFFECTS OF NEURAL ACTIVITY, INCLUDING BY NOT LIMITED TO PUPIL DILATION, MOTOR ACTIVITY, AND BREATHING RATE.

~~(9)(10)(11)~~ "Person" means an individual, partnership, corporation, association, business, business trust, or legal representative of an organization.

~~(10)(11)(12)~~ "Processor" means a person that processes genetic data on behalf of an entity pursuant to a contract between the entity and the processor that prohibits the processor from retaining, using, or disclosing the genetic data, or any information regarding the identity of the consumer, including whether that consumer has solicited or received genetic testing, as applicable, for any purpose other than for the specific purpose of performing the services specified in the contract.

~~(11)(12)(13)~~ "Third party" means a person other than the consumer, entity, or processor."

**Section 3.** Section 30-23-103, MCA, is amended to read:

**"30-23-103. Exceptions.** (1) This part does not apply to:

(a) protected health information that is collected by a covered entity or business associate as those terms are defined in 45 CFR, parts 160 and 164, if separate informed consent related to the collection, use, and dissemination of genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data is obtained from the consumer, parent, guardian, or power of attorney, and the covered entity or business associate follows the policies under 30-23-104(6)(a) through (6)(d);

(b) an entity when it is engaged only in collecting, using, or analyzing genetic ~~or neural~~ data or biological samples in the context of SCIENTIFIC OR CLINICAL research ~~as defined in 45 CFR 164.501~~ conducted with the express consent of an individual and in accordance with:

(i) the federal policy for the protection of human research subjects under 45 CFR, part 46, the good clinical practice guideline issued by the international council for harmonisation of technical requirements for pharmaceuticals for human use; or

(ii) the United States food and drug administration policy for the protection of human subjects under 21 CFR, parts 50 and 56; or

(c) uses by a governmental agency; OR

(D) DEIDENTIFIED GENETIC DATA OBTAINED FROM A THIRD PARTY TO THE EXTENT THAT THE DATA IS USED TO CONDUCT INTERNAL, MEDICAL, OR SCIENTIFIC RESEARCH. DATA MUST BE CONSIDERED DEIDENTIFIED IF:

(I) IT CANNOT BE REASONABLY LINKED TO AN IDENTIFIABLE INDIVIDUAL; AND

(II) THE ENTITY:

(A) TAKES ADMINISTRATIVE AND TECHNICAL MEASURES TO ENSURE THE DATA CANNOT BE ASSOCIATED WITH A PARTICULAR CONSUMER;

(B) MAINTAINS AND USES DATA IN DEIDENTIFIED FORM AND DOES NOT ATTEMPT TO REIDENTIFY DATA; AND

(C) ENTERS A LEGALLY ENFORCEABLE CONTRACTUAL OBLIGATION THAT PROHIBITS A RECIPIENT OF THE DATA FROM ATTEMPTING TO REIDENTIFY THE DATA.

(2) ~~Beginning June 1, 2025, any~~ Any collection, storage, use, or dissemination of genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data by a governmental agency must be performed in accordance with a specific state law or executed through a search warrant or investigative subpoena issued pursuant to 46-4-301."

**Section 4.** Section 30-23-104, MCA, is amended to read:

**"30-23-104. Consumer genetic or NEURAL NEUROTECHNOLOGY data -- privacy notice -- consent -- access -- deletion -- destruction.** To safeguard the privacy, confidentiality, security, and integrity of a consumer's genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data, an entity shall:

(1) provide clear and complete information regarding the entity's policies and procedures for the collection, use, or disclosure of genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data by making available to a consumer:

(a) a high-level privacy policy overview that includes basic, essential information about the entity's collection, use, or disclosure of genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data; and

(b) a prominent, publicly available privacy notice that includes, at a minimum, information about the

entity's data collection, consent, use, access, disclosure, transfer, security, and retention and deletion practices  
for genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data;

(2) obtain initial express consent from a consumer, parent, guardian, or power of attorney for the  
collection, use, or disclosure of the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data that:

(a) clearly describes the entity's use of the genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data that the entity  
collects through the entity's genetic testing product or service;

(b) specifies the categories of individuals within the entity that have access to test results; and

(c) specifies how the entity may share the genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data;

(3) if the entity engages in any of the following, obtain a consumer's:

(a) separate express consent for:

(i) the transfer or disclosure of the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data or  
biological sample to any third party other than the entity's processors, including the name of the third party to  
which the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data or biological sample will be transferred or  
disclosed with the consumer's express consent;

(ii) the use of genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data beyond the primary purpose of the entity's  
genetic testing product or service and inherent contextual uses; or

(iii) the entity's retention of any biological sample provided by the consumer following the entity's  
completion of the initial testing service requested by the consumer;

(b) informed express consent for transfer or disclosure of the consumer's genetic ~~or~~  
~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data to third party persons for:

(i) research purposes; or

(ii) research conducted under the control of the entity for the purpose of publication or  
generalizable knowledge; and

(c) express consent for:

(i) marketing to a consumer based on the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data;

(ii) marketing by a third-party person to a consumer based on the consumer having ordered or  
purchased a genetic\_testing product or service. Marketing does not include the provision of customized content  
or offers on the websites or through the applications or services provided by the entity with the first-party

relationship to the consumer; or

(iii) sale or other valuable consideration of the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data.

(4) comply with the provisions of 44-6-104 requiring a valid legal process for disclosing genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data to law enforcement or any other government agency without a consumer's express consent;

(5) develop, implement, and maintain a comprehensive security program to protect a consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data against unauthorized access, use, or disclosure; and

(6) provide a process for a consumer to:

(a) access the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data;

(b) delete the consumer's genetic ~~or neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data;

(c) revoke any consent provided by the consumer; and

(d) request and obtain the destruction of the consumer's biological sample.

(7) The requirements of subsections (6)(a) through (6)(d) must be waived if:

(a) the entity obtains express and informed written consent from a consumer, parent, guardian, or power of attorney for participation in a clinical research trial, including the collection and use of any genetic or neural NEUROTECHNOLOGY data, which at a minimum must:

(i) be in accordance with the good clinical practice guideline issued by the international council for harmonisation of technical requirements for pharmaceuticals for human use;

(ii) be obtained no sooner than 14 days from the initial biological sample collection if the biological sample is collected for a primary purpose unrelated to clinical research;

(iii) be obtained separately from any other items of consent;

(iv) be in writing on a form with text that is easily readable with size 12-point font or larger;

(v) include the entity's biological sample and data retention, sharing, and use policies;

(vi) include notice that after consent is given, there is no right to access, inspect, or require the destruction of any genetic or neural biological sample or NEUROTECHNOLOGY data; and

(vii) include notice that after consent is given, whole genome sequencing of the individual's biological sample could occur and is permitted without further notice to the individual;

(b) the genetic or neural biological sample and data is utilized for clinical research purposes only.

(8) The requirements of subsection (6)(d) must be temporarily waived if:

(a) a laboratory is governed under 42 CFR 493.1105;

(b) the laboratory retains the biological sample for no more than 2 years or the shortest time allowed under law, whichever is less;

(c) the laboratory does not share, test, or conduct additional analysis or research on the biological sample while the sample is being held under the retention requirements set forth in 42 CFR 493.1105 prior to the requested destruction of the sample; and

(d) when a clinical laboratory is certified by the centers for medicare and medicaid services, when the retention of a patient's biological sample does not exceed the time needed for compliance with any quality standard or regulation issued pursuant to section 263(a) of the Public Health Service Act, 42 U.S.C. 263(a).

(9) The requirements of subsection (7) supersede all exceptions to, and waivers of, informed consent in the federal policy for the protection of human subjects under 45 CFR, part 46.

(7)(10) Genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data and biometric samples of Montana residents collected in the state may not be stored within the territorial boundaries of any country currently sanctioned in any way by the United States office of foreign asset control or designated as a foreign adversary under 15 CFR 7.4(a). Genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data or biometric data of Montana residents collected in the state may only be transferred or stored outside the United States with the consent of the resident."

**Section 5.** Section 30-23-105, MCA, is amended to read:

**"30-23-105. Disclosure -- when prohibited -- when express consent required.** (1) The disclosure of genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data pursuant to this part must comply with all state and federal laws for the protection of privacy and security.

(2) Notwithstanding any other provisions in 30-23-104, an entity may not disclose a consumer's genetic or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data to any entity offering health insurance, life insurance, or long-term care insurance, or to any employer of the consumer without the consumer's express consent."

**Section 6.** Section 44-6-104, MCA, is amended to read:



1           **"44-6-104. Consumer DNA or NEURAL NEUROTECHNOLOGY database searches -- familial DNA or**  
2           **NEURAL NEUROTECHNOLOGY searches -- warrant required.** (1) A government entity may not obtain DNA or  
3           ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY search results from a consumer DNA or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY database:  
4           (a)       without a search warrant or investigative subpoena issued by a court on a finding of probable  
5           cause; or  
6           (b)       unless the consumer whose information is sought previously waived the consumer's right to  
7           privacy in the information.  
8           (2)       A government entity may not obtain familial DNA or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data search  
9           results or search results from partial matching from the DNA or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY identification index or  
10          a consumer DNA or ~~neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY database without a search warrant or investigative subpoena  
11          issued by a court on a finding of probable cause.  
12          (3)       For the purposes of this section, the following definitions apply:  
13          (a)       "Consumer DNA database" means a database maintained by a private entity that provides  
14          direct-to-consumer genetic testing services.  
15          (b)       "DNA identification index" has the same meaning provided in 44-6-101.  
16          (c)       "Familial DNA search" means a search performed of a government or consumer DNA database  
17          using specialized software to detect and statistically rank a list of potential candidates in the DNA database who  
18          may be a close biological relative to the unknown individual contributing the evidence DNA profile. The  
19          specialized software search may be combined with lineage testing to help confirm or refute biological  
20          relatedness.  
21          (d)       "Lineage testing" means additional genetic testing used to help confirm or refute biological  
22          relatedness between the known individual in a DNA database and the unknown individual contributing the  
23          evidence DNA profile. Examples of additional genetic testing include but are not limited to:  
24          (i)       Y-STR analysis to examine STR patterns specific to the Y-chromosome used to determine  
25          paternally derived relatedness among DNA profiles;  
26          (ii)       mtDNA analysis to examine cell mitochondria used to determine maternally derived  
27          relatedness; or  
28          (iii)       single nucleotide polymorphism genotyping to generate results related to a person's ancestry

and genetic predisposition to health-related topics.

(e) ~~"Neural~~ NEUROTECHNOLOGY data" has the same meaning as provided in 30-23-102.

(e)(f) "Partial matching" means a moderate stringency search of a DNA database using routine search parameters that results in one or more partial matches between single-source and nondegraded DNA profiles that share at least one allele at each locus, indicating a potential familial relationship between the known individual in the DNA database and the unknown individual contributing the evidence DNA profile.

(4) ~~A government entity that legally obtains DNA or neural-NEUROTECHNOLOGY data search results,~~  
~~as set forth in this section, or genetic or neural-NEUROTECHNOLOGY data, as set forth in Title 30, chapter 23, part~~  
~~1, may use the results during criminal investigations and judicial proceedings subject to applicable rules of~~  
~~criminal procedure and evidence."~~

- END -